Project Title: Agri – Diversity in One Cent Farming

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Abstract: “Agri-Diversity in One Cent Farming” is a project in agriculture originated in Sacred Heart Upper Primary School (SHUPS), a small school in Kuttanadu, which tries to fulfill the aims envisioned by the STEM4Girls. The school already has established in setting up a vegetable and a medicinal garden and has been a center of excellence for many years. Kuttanadu in Allappuzha District is also known as “The Granary” and “The Rice Bowl of Kerala”, and it is the only place in the world where farming is done up to two meters below the sea level (Keralatourism.org). Up to the year 2018, our land was almost food secure by its own farming practices. But the great flood of 2018 became a threat for the food security of the locality. The land subsidence caused by the great flood made it even worse and almost a third of the year the land was under the threat of floods. The after effects of Covid 19 in 2020 also made the farming and economy to suffer.

In this context, integrated farming through integrated methods is both important and relevant. If the farming in only one cent of land can be tested, this could be projected to 10 cents of land, and then to one acre, as a solution to the difficulties faced by the communities. For this we will take a new approach as the combination of new generational farming techniques – like hydroponic farming, aquaponic farming, vertical farming, wick farming and aquatic farming – in a systematic way within one cent of land. Through this, we can transform the vulnerable communities of Kuttanadu from their problems to the possibilities of the community.